BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

My tests and treatment checks

Routine safety tests, symptom-driven tests and response scans have different purposes.

Check	Before starting	Treatment visits	Between visits	Next cycle / phase	After treatment
Blood and organ checks	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms. dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) testing before first fluorouracil unless already tested; kidney measurement and hearing assessment as indicated. Arrange dental and swallowing/nutrition review before head and neck radiation.	Before each cycle: full blood count, kidney and liver tests. Review weight, eating, drinking, swallowing, mouth symptoms, hands and feet. Kidney measurement and hearing tests follow the source and individual plan.	Extra tests may be needed for symptoms or abnormal results.	Review results, recovery and earlier toxicity before another dose.	The team follows recovery, response and persistent side effects. Scans and tumour tests follow the individual plan; there is no universal scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen.
Treatment and appointments	Confirm the complete treatment plan.	Carboplatin runs over 30 minutes on each of Days 1–4. Fluorouracil runs continuously over 96 hours; the source also permits a separate 22-hour infusion on each of Days 1–4. Confirm the actual pump or bag-change and disconnection times.	Follow written medicine and contact instructions.	Chemotherapy is given only during radiotherapy. If radiation is interrupted, contact the team before the next chemotherapy dose. Radiation oncology sets the radiation visits and follow-up.	Record completion and the named follow-up team.
Mouth, weight and swallowing	Assess symptoms, teeth, eating and drinking.	Review weight, intake and mouth symptoms.	Call for difficulty swallowing, worsening pain or weight loss.	Dietitian and swallowing support according to need.	Continue rehabilitation and dental care if advised.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00589 v5: retrieved official regimen

Tests in your plan

Full blood count

WHEN

Before each cycle.

Checks infection-fighting cells, oxygen-carrying cells and platelets for clotting.

Kidney and liver tests

WHEN

Before each cycle: full blood count, kidney and liver tests. Review weight, eating, drinking, swallowing, mouth symptoms, hands and feet. Kidney measurement and hearing tests follow the source and individual plan.

Checks treatment handling and organ safety.

DPD assessment

WHEN

Before first fluorouracil unless previously tested.

Checks risk of unusually severe fluorouracil toxicity; a normal result does not exclude all risk.

Hearing assessment

If part of your plan

WHEN

When clinically indicated.

Assesses existing or new hearing changes and tinnitus.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Four-day carboplatin and fluorouracil with radiotherapy: treatment and checks

Locally advanced head and neck squamous cell cancer when cisplatin is unsuitable. Source eligibility specifically describes stage III/intravenous (IV) oropharyngeal cancer without distant metastases.

Carboplatin 70 mg/m² each day on Days 1–4, with fluorouracil 600 mg/m²/day on Days 1–4, every 21 days for 3 cycles, only concurrently with radiotherapy.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Treatment visits	Between visits	Next cycle / phase	After treatment
Blood and organ checks NCCP	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms. DPD testing before first fluorouracil unless already tested; kidney measurement and hearing assessment as indicated. Arrange dental and swallowing/ nutrition review before head and neck radiation.	Before each cycle: full blood count, kidney and liver tests. Review weight, eating, drinking, swallowing, mouth symptoms, hands and feet. Kidney measurement and hearing tests follow the source and individual plan.	Extra tests may be needed for symptoms or abnormal results.	Review results, recovery and earlier toxicity before another dose.	The team follows recovery, response and persistent side effects. Scans and tumour tests follow the individual plan; there is no universal scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen.
Treatment and appointments NCCP	Confirm the complete treatment plan.	Carboplatin runs over 30 minutes on each of Days 1–4. Fluorouracil runs continuously over 96 hours; the source also permits a separate 22-hour infusion on each of Days 1–4. Confirm the actual pump or bag-change and disconnection times.	Follow written medicine and contact instructions.	Chemotherapy is given only during radiotherapy. If radiation is interrupted, contact the team before the next chemotherapy dose. Radiation oncology sets the radiation visits and follow-up.	Record completion and the named follow-up team.
Mouth, weight and swallowing NCCP	Assess symptoms, teeth, eating and drinking.	Review weight, intake and mouth symptoms.	Call for difficulty swallowing, worsening pain or weight loss.	Dietitian and swallowing support according to need.	Continue rehabilitation and dental care if advised.

What each check is for

1 Treatment course

Days 1–4: both drugs. Every 21 days ×3, during radiotherapy.

Chemotherapy is given with radiation to improve control of cancer in the head and neck. Your team confirms that this particular four-day carboplatin schedule suits your cancer and health.

Ask / act: Confirm active medicines, safety checks and support plan.

Sources: NCCP

2 Review / next phase

After the planned course and recovery review

Review response and recovery.

Ask / act: Confirm actual dates and the next prescription.

Sources: NCCP

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-11 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.49